

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 48 OF 64

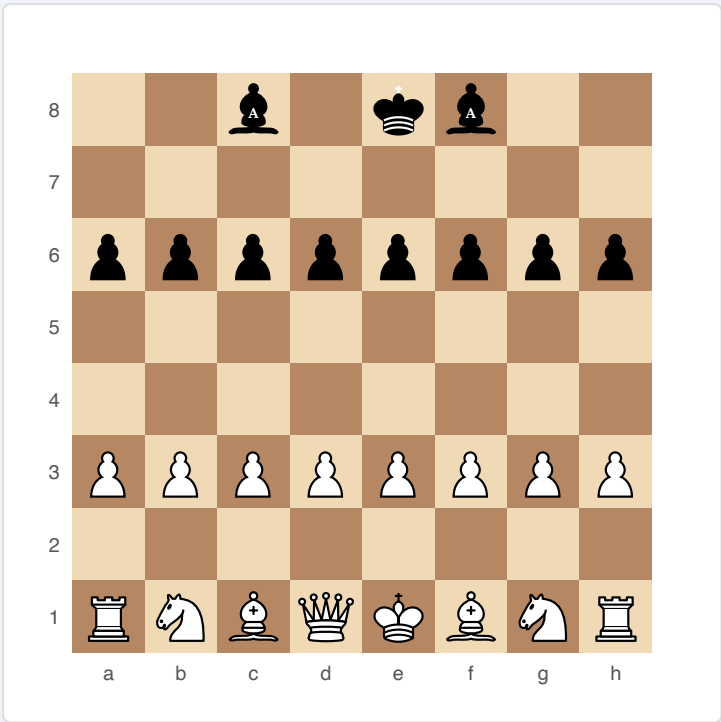
# Orda Chess

**8×8**  
BOARD

**2**  
PLAYERS

# ORDA CHESS

An asymmetric variant where White plays standard chess and Black commands the Mongol Horde — pieces that move differently from how they capture.



*Orda Chess — starting position*

## SETUP

**Board:** Standard 8×8.

**White (standard):** Standard chess setup.

**Black (Horde):** Pawns on rank 7. Back rank: Lancer, Archer, Kheshig, Khan, Yurt, Kheshig, Archer, Lancer.

**FEN:** `lhaykahl/8/pppppppp/8/8/PPPPPPP/8/RNBQKBNR w KQ - 0 1`

## RULES

**Yurt (y)** — Moves one square diagonally. Captures one square orthogonally. (Replaces the Queen.)

**Lancer (l)** — Moves like a Rook (slides orthogonally). Captures like a Knight (L-shaped jump). Cannot slide to capture.

**Archer (h)** — Moves like a Bishop (slides diagonally). Captures like a Knight (L-shaped jump). Cannot slide to capture.

**Khan (k)** — Moves and captures as a standard King.

**Kheshig** — Standard Knight movement and capture.

- ♦ White can castle. Black cannot (the Khan starts on e8).
- ♦ Black's Lancers and Archers have split movement: they slide freely for non-capturing moves but must jump (like a Knight) to capture.
- ♦ Standard pawns for both sides.

## WIN CONDITION

Checkmate the opponent's King/Khan.

## STRATEGY

Black's Lancers and Archers are powerful positional pieces (full rook/bishop mobility) but limited attackers (knight-range capture only). White must exploit the Horde's short capture range while avoiding their positional dominance. Black should use Lancers for long-range control and coordinate Archers for knight-distance attacks.

## ATTRIBUTION

Designed by Couch Tomato (2020). Popularised on Pychess. Public domain.